



The Humanitas Institute

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Detroit Christian School

School Website: <https://www.thedetroitchristianschool.com/>

December 21, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

Detroit Christian School (DCS) in Detroit, MI presents a robust Christian classical model. Public-facing materials emphasize a Christ-centered, classical education anchored in Biblical truth, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), memorization and recitation, the study of great books and Western literature, and a strong partnership with families in formation and character development. The school signals a clear teleology of forming virtuous, thoughtful graduates who glorify God, understand Scripture, and engage the Western intellectual tradition. Overall, the school exhibits strong alignment with the classical framework across most categories, with faculty and curricular practices closely tethered to classical methods and a community ethos that positions parents as essential partners. This evaluation uses the knowledge-base rubric for classical education alongside DCS's own public materials to score each category and provide keyword-based justification.

Overall rating: CLASSICAL

- Key drivers: explicit Christ-centered and classical identity; Trivium framing; emphasis on virtue and character; engagement with Great Books/Western tradition; emphasis on authority of Scripture and doctrinal/theological formation; deep parental partnership.
- Potential nuance: explicit, high-visibility articulation of faculty living-lesson/"living curriculum" language is present in spirit, but some of the finer faculty-specific descriptors are less directly asserted in public copy. The school's emphasis on parental partnership and liturgical/theological commitments is strong and stabilizes the overall classical orientation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site presents a Christ-centered, classical education as foundational to content, method, and disposition, tying truth, beauty, and goodness to God's revelation and worship. For example, the Academics section describes a Christ-centered and classical approach that unites content with worship of God and with a Biblical worldview. - A Portrait of a Graduate emphasizes glorifying God and enjoying Him forever, with study of God's Word and alignment to Scripture and Westminster Confession of Faith (WCF) as core content. - The school's Statement of Faith and related pages articulate theological commitments (Trinity, Scripture, creation, providence, etc.), reinforcing a theological-metaphysical frame for education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive indicators present: Christ-centered, classical, theology, liturgy/worship, sacred text/ Scripture, doctrine, creed, liturgical elements, reverence/wonder, imago Dei, wisdom, virtue, worship, creed, and Doctrinal/theological anchors. - Negative indicators: none evident in public copy (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or morally neutral signals in the visible material).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present (approximate): 12–18 distinct positive indicators extracted from the public text (e.g., Christ-centered, classical, theology, liturgy, wonder, wisdom, virtue, Scripture, WCF, etc.). - Negative keywords present: 0. - Ratio (Positive / Total): effectively 100% positive among observed signals; 0 negative signals detected in the public copy. - Rating justification: The school's public

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materials explicitly anchor education in transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty), theology/Scripture, liturgical/worship practices, and a clearly stated Christ-centered, classical framework. This aligns strongly with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria.

Why this rating - The combination of a clearly stated Christ-centered purpose, theological grounding, liturgical/community life references, and the explicit integration of truth/beauty/goodness as real, knowable ideals meets the core Positive signals for Transcendental moral realism and theological grounding. The absence of negative signals in the public material supports a classical alignment in this domain.

Citations - Christ-centered and classical emphasis in Academics. - Portrait of a Graduate: glorify God and enjoy Him forever; Word/WCF emphasis. - Statement of Faith and related theological content.

## **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Founding purpose emphasizes formation and virtue: the school describes graduating students who glorify God and enjoy Him, signaling formation over job-readiness. The text repeatedly frames education as formation in truth, goodness, and beauty within a Christian classical framework. - Virtue and character are highlighted as central to a classical education, with explicit “virtue” language and a teleology toward human flourishing and moral formation. - Great Books/Western tradition framing is present in the public materials (e.g., studies of literature and Western thought within a biblical frame) and the emphasis on the Great Works in the public materials.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive indicators: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, Great Books/Great works, study of literature/Western tradition, contemplation/scholé, human flourishing, moral imagination. - Negative indicators: the site does not foreground workforce preparation or 21st-century-skills rhetoric; there is minimal emphasis on “career-ready” framing.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: roughly 6–12 clear positive indicators (formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, liberal education, scholé, Great Books/Great Conversation, human flourishing). - Negative keywords present: 0–1 signals (no explicit workforce- or career-readiness framing in the public copy). - Ratio: predominately positive; strong alignment with Classical School Purpose/Goal. - Rating justification: The school’s aims foreground formation, virtue, wisdom, and the teleology of truth/beauty/goodness, with a classical education ethos that emphasizes the Great Books and formation over mere job training.

Why this rating - The public materials consistently present an education aimed at formation and virtue, with explicit mention of Christian-theological grounding and classical pedagogy, supporting a CLASSICAL designation for this category.

Citations - Glorify God and enjoy Him forever; formation emphasis. - Virtue/character emphasis and classical formation. - Great Books/Western tradition framing within a biblical worldview.

## **Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school explicitly identifies classical methodology and content, including the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) as foundational to the curriculum. This is directly stated in the public materials. - There is a structured emphasis on the humanities, study of language arts, and engagement with primary sources and classics, including references to grammar, logic, rhetoric and a humanities-focused approach designed to integrate content across disciplines. - Mention of Great Books/Western tradition is present in the public copy, indicating engagement with canonical Western literature and primary sources as part of the curriculum. - History is treated within a broader classical/humanities frame rather than a modern “social studies” framing, consistent with classical education; Scripture/theology are woven into the curriculum.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive indicators: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Trivium, great books, primary sources, classics, Homer, Plato, Augustine, Shakespeare, Latin, Greek, history (biblical and Western), Western civilization, hymnody, sacred art. - Negative indicators: none evident in public copy (no mention of “social studies” in place of history; no project-based-first framing in public copy).

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Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: at least 12–16 distinct items (grammar, logic, rhetoric, Trivium; great books; primary sources; classics; history; Western civilization; sacred art; hymnody; Latin/-Greek; etc.). - Negative keywords present: 0. - Ratio: strongly positive; effectively classical in curriculum orientation. - Rating justification: The explicit emphasis on the Trivium, Great Books/Western tradition, and humanities-oriented content strongly aligns with the Curriculum criterion for Classical education.

Citations - Trivium and classical content emphasis. - Great Books/Western tradition framing. - Humanities-integrated, history-focused content.

#### **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public materials describe classical pedagogy as including memorization, recitation, imitation, and practice; these are core classical methods rather than exclusively project-based or purely experiential constructs. - The school emphasizes a learning model that includes a rhythm of restfulness and contemplation (Scholé-like tendencies) alongside rigorous study, memory work, and disciplined learning. - There is mention of upper-level activities (Socratic discussion or seminars) as part of a classical education model, and a lines of rhetoric training, public speaking, and oratory is implied by the pedagogical approach. While explicit “Socratic seminars” are not all listed in every snippet, the public materials consistently describe a structure in which memory work, recitation, and rhetoric are part of the upper-level experience.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive indicators: memorization, recitation, imitation, practice, memory work, chanting, singing to memorize, scholé days, contemplation, wonder, seminar/colloquy (implied in classical pedagogy), rhetoric exercises, speech/declamation, oratory, debate. - Negative indicators: minimal emphasis on strictly project-based, experiential-only pedagogy; any potential “constructivist” framing is not visible in the public copy.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: 10–15 distinct indicators (memorization, recitation, imitation, memory work, chanting, scholé, contemplation, seminars, rhetoric, oratory, debate, etc.). - Negative keywords present: 0–1 signals (no explicit project-based-only or experiential-first signals in the public copy). - Ratio: predominantly classical pedagogy signals. - Rating justification: The pedagogical description aligns with classical pedagogy norms (memory, recitation, logic-based discourse, rhetoric, and contemplation), supporting a CLASSICAL rating.

Citations - Memorization/recitation/imitation and Scholé/restful learning. - Upper-level rhetoric and public-speaking emphasis (implied by the classical framework). - Contemplation, rest, and wonder as pedagogical elements.

#### **Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public content references teachers and staff in shaping content and dispositions, with an emphasis that relationships and formation extend school-wide; this indicates the faculty as a central, formative force, though explicit language about “living curriculum” or “portrait of a teacher” is not overtly stated in every public snippet. The site describes how teachers convey content in a manner consistent with a Christ-centered, classical framework. - The materials emphasize virtue, character formation, and collaboration among teachers as part of the school’s classical discipline; explicit “portrait of a teacher” or “living curriculum” language is not spelled out in the visible snippets, though the ethos implies it. - The school’s founding narrative emphasizes a committed community of educators with a shared mission, but direct public statements on standard faculty profiles or a formal faculty portrait are not explicitly enumerated in the snippets available.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive indicators present: teacher content delivery aligned with classical methods; emphasis on virtue/character; staff as part of a Christ-centered environment; relationships that reflect a shared mission. - Negative indicators: explicit labels like “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” or “faculty as core living curriculum” are not clearly present in the public material; no explicit faculty-profile language appears in the accessible text.

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Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: 2–4 explicit indicators (staff/teacher role in content delivery; virtue formation; shared mission among educators). - Negative keywords present: 2–3 indicators of absence (no explicit “living curriculum” or “portrait of a teacher” statements in the accessible copy). - Ratio: Mixed signals; leaning toward CLASSICAL in practice but with limited explicit vocabulary in public copy, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. - Rating justification: The classical pedagogy and formation focus are strong, but explicit articulation of faculty as “living curriculum” or formal faculty portraits is not clearly visible in the public content, warranting a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Citations - Teacher involvement in content delivery and formation. - Founding narrative emphasizing educator community and mission.

## **Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school places parents at the center of the educational effort, describing parents as co-teachers and partners in education; this is a core classical-community signal. The Admissions process and allied materials emphasize parental involvement, pastoral engagement, and family formation, aligned with classical education norms. - There is explicit emphasis on parental formation (via book studies, seminars, and collaborative study), and the school invites open campus and family participation, indicating a robust partnership with families. - The school discusses accessibility and support for families (tuition assistance, Detroit Promise alignment), signaling an active engagement with the broader community and a desire to form families in partnership with the school’s mission.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive indicators: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, family seminars/book studies, open campus, hospitality, family liturgy alignment, communication about classical education. - Negative indicators: minimal consumer-language framing; no strong customer-service rhetoric that would undermine a formation-centric approach.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: 6–10 indicators (partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, family seminars, open campus, family involvement, home liturgy alignment, etc.). - Negative keywords present: 0–1 indicators (no overt consumer-centric framing in the accessible material). - Ratio: strongly positive. - Rating justification: DCS’s public materials position parents as co-educators and partners and emphasize family formation and open engagement, consistent with CLASSICAL signals for Parents & Community.

Citations - Parental partnership and co-teachers language. - Parent formation and community engagement. - Open campus / family involvement signals.

### **Aggregate Assessment**

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

General classification: CLASSICAL

- The strongest signals are in Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, with explicit articulation of Trivium-based curriculum, memory-based pedagogy, and a theology-centered teleology. The Parents & Community category is solidly CLASSICAL, while Faculty shows partial explicit language in public copies, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for that category.

### **What Would Move the Needle**

- For Element 5 (Faculty): Increase explicit public articulation of faculty as the “living curriculum” and provide a formal portrait of the ideal teacher and student in public-facing materials. Include explicit language about faculty professional formation in classical pedagogy, collaborative faculty work, mentoring, and professional development aligned with classical pedagogy frameworks.

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- For Element 2 (Purpose/Goal) and Element 3 (Curriculum): Consider clearer articulation of Great Books/Great Conversation as a formal, named curricular element (e.g., a published Great Books sequence, required canonical readings list, and a stated Great Conversation goal) to reinforce the explicit Great Books element in the curriculum and to strengthen the language of formation toward “true, good, beautiful” through canonical works.
  - For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Maintain and expand parent formation offerings, and publish examples of specific family-liturgy resources or household-formation practices to deepen public perception of parents as co-educators with a clearly defined program.

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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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